



PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

THIRD MEETING, 2025

Wednesday, 5th November, 2025

*The House met at the Chamber,
Parliament House, at 2:36 p.m.*

[FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER, MR
BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE
CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, there being no Message from the President and Formal Communication by the Speaker, we now take the item numbered 5, Correction of *Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Reports*.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND
THE OFFICIAL REPORT**

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I have in my hands, *Votes and Proceedings* of Tuesday, 4th November, 2025 and it is for correction.

Page 1...10 —

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, thank you so much. Respectfully, on page 9, the item numbered 8, under the title “Questions”, I think the proper and full rendition of the Ministry in question currently, should read, “Ministry of Fisheries and Aquaculture Development”.

The Clerks-at-the-Table could kindly check.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Table Office, kindly cross check.

Page 10...11.

Hon Members, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Tuesday, 4th November, 2025, as presented and corrected is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we have two Official Reports; Official Reports of Thursday 23rd October, 2025 and Friday, 24th October, 2025. We shall start with that of Thursday, 23rd October, 2025. It is for correction.

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Thursday, 23rd October, 2025.]

We now turn to the *Official Report* of Friday, 24th October, 2025. Hon Members, any correction?

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Friday, 24th October, 2025.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the item numbered 6, Questions.

Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, we had scheduled some Questions mostly to the Minister for Roads and Highways, but

because of the inauguration for one of the major road infrastructure projects in the Savannah Region, we had to reschedule it to tomorrow. So, we do not have any major Business in that regard. The Minister for Sports and Recreation is not immediately available to answer the one Question that has been advertised. So, I will urge that we take the Statements.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Leader, in doing so, is it possible for the Minister to be here? I would want us to defer the Question. Majority Leader, is the Minister here?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the Minister is a Member of Parliament. He has a seat. I do not know why he is even sitting there in the first place. And you have not invited him to sit there to respond to Questions. Mr Speaker, let the Minister take his rightful space. If you so direct that he should come and sit there and respond to the Questions, then he can do so.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, you may remain seated. Please, sit down.

Question number 351, standing in the name of Mr Dickson Kyere-Duah, Member for Berekum East Constituency. You have the floor.

Mr Kyere-Duah: Thank you, Mr Speaker. It is rather Berekum West and not East.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I am looking at what is contained in the *Order Paper*, so thanks for the correction.

ORAL ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF SPORTS AND RECREATION

The Current Status of the Jinijini AstroTurf

2:46 p.m.

Mr Dickson Kyere-Duah (NDC—Berekum West): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Sports and Recreation the current status of the Jinijini AstroTurf which was started after the 2024 elections but has been stalled since March 2025.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, you have the floor.

Minister for Sport and Recreation (Kofi Iddie Adams): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, the Jinijini AstroTurf was not awarded by the Ministry of Sports and Recreation, although we take keen interest in its development given its alignment with our mandate. Our checks revealed that, Ghana Gas is actually constructing the facility for the Berekum West District Assembly. The right institution to provide you with this detailed answer is the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you, Hon Minister.

Hon Member for Berekum West, any supplementary question?

Mr Kyere-Duah: Mr Speaker, I followed up with the contractor who claimed the contract was given to him by the then Ministry of Youth and Sports. That was what the contractor told me, and he said in March, he got a letter from the Ministry of Sports and Recreation that the work be suspended—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I think you know the rules. You are to ask a supplementary question.

Mr Kyere-Duah: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. May I follow up with the hardworking Minister for Sports and Recreation — *[Interruption]*— that, judging from the fact that Berekum West is an epicentre for sports in Bono Region, with six Division Two clubs, but not a single playing surface, and for that matter, the teams are compelled to travel to Sunyani West to play their matches. As a hard-working Minister for Sport and Recreation, what is he going to do to ensure that the good people of Berekum West and for that matter the six Division Two clubs get a befitting playing surface? Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, this is an entirely new Question—*[Laughter]*. Your question was specific regarding the completion of the Jinijini AstroTurf. That was your Question. Hon Minister, are you minded to answer this Question?

Mr K.I. Adams: Mr Speaker, let me assure the Hon Member that following his Question, I have shown some interest in the project and that was what led me to Ghana Gas. So, I am engaging Ghana

Gas and I believe strongly that some funding is being arranged for the contractor to be able to get back to site. So, his question has already yielded something positive.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any further supplementary question?

Mr Kyere-Duah: Not really, Mr Speaker, except to thank the hardworking Minister. Mr Speaker, we have seen an upgrade on the playing surface of the Accra Sports Stadium in our recent matches. I know with him, I am secured. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Member.

Yes?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I have a supplementary question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I thought this was a constituency-specific Question? The Question is about the Jinijini AstroTurf.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Yes, Mr Speaker, it is about AstroTurf. The questioner at the later part of his Question said, the AstroTurf which was started after the 2024 Election but has been stalled— So, Mr Speaker, I wanted to find out from the Minister whether he knows when the contract was awarded, even though he indicated in his Answer that it is not the Ministry which is constructing it but rather Ghana Gas.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon First Deputy Minority Whip, I think the questioner is clear that the AstroTurf started after the 2024 Election. The question, therefore, is when was the 2024 Election conducted? So, the questioner is saying after that, it was—

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, it can be the case that the contract can be awarded before the 2024 Election, but the contract might start after 2024. So, I want to know when the contract was awarded.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Hon Minister said the contract is not emanating from his Ministry.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, not to belabour the point, this is a very politically-inclined question to imply that the AstroTurf in Berekum was awarded after the 2024 Election. I am aware, unless the Minister would dispute the fact that the said contract was not awarded after 2024. If it started after 2024, that is what I wanted to find out from the Minister, when this contract was awarded. The Hon Member said it started after the 2024 Election, but when was it awarded?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But is the Ministry of Sports and Recreation the awarding ministry?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, ask him the question. I am only asking a supplementary question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, supplementary question disallowed.

Yes?

Alhaji Mumuni Nurideen Muhammed: Thank you very much. Mr Speaker, I want to find out from the Minister, as a Minister in charge of our sports facilities in Ghana, how many uncompleted AstroTurf do we have currently in Ghana?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, Question humbly disallowed.

Hon Members, as indicated, this is a constituency-specific Question.

I use the opportunity to thank the Hon Minister for Sports and Recreation very much for attending upon the House to respond to the Questions. Hon Minister, thank you very much. You are discharged.

Hon Members, we move to the item numbered 7, and it is Statements. The first Statement is standing in the name of the Hon Member for Jomoro, Dorcas Toffey. Hon Member, you have the floor.

Well, I would move to the second Statement, standing in the name of Mr Akwasi Konadu. Hon Member, you have the floor.

STATEMENTS

The Rising Number of Deaths Due to Illegal Mining

Mr Akwasi Konadu (NPP — Manhyia North): Mr Speaker, the Statement is on the console. It is digitalisation finally.

Mr Speaker, I am grateful for the opportunity to deliver this important Statement on the increasing number of deaths associated with illegal mining, commonly referred to as *galamsey*. The situation we face today is not only alarming, but also a direct indictment on our collective national failure to adequately regulate an activity that continues to destroy our land, endanger lives, and weaken the very foundation of our natural and human capital. Mr Speaker, illegal small-scale mining is not a new phenomenon. Its historical antecedents can be traced to the pre-colonial era, where gold mining formed an essential part of indigenous livelihoods.

2:56 p.m.

However, the 1980s ushered in a new era of “landscape extractivism” driven by structural adjustment programmes that opened our lands to multinational firms for large-scale mining. These policies, while economically strategic, inadvertently marginalised many Ghanaians, pushing them into small-scale mining—A sector that was poorly regulated and largely ignored by the state.

Mr Speaker, after four decades, the legacy of neglect and informality has transformed small-scale mining into one of the gravest threats facing our country. Today, illegal mining activities not only degrade the environment but are increasingly claiming innocent lives. Despite Ghana being a signatory to numerous environmental and sustainable development protocols, our current trajectory undermines these commitments.

Mr Speaker, the implications of *galamsey* extend far beyond environmental degradation. They directly threaten human life. For instance, from January to July, 2025, Ghana has recorded at least 17 reported deaths linked directly to *galamsey* activities. Mr Speaker, these are not mere statistics; these are Ghanaian lives: breadwinners, mothers, sons, and daughters lost to the reckless pursuit of unregulated mineral wealth.

Mr Speaker, I seek your leave to recount some recent and tragic incidents. On 8th January, 2025, two young men lost their lives in Osino, Fanteakwa District, following the collapse of a *galamsey* pit. They were part of a group of seven operating in the pit during the early hours of the morning when the structure gave way and buried them alive. Just twelve days later, the nation woke up to the news of a violent confrontation between armed illegal miners and the joint military-security team of AngloGold Ashanti at their Obuasi concession. In their attempt to forcefully breach a fenced operational area, eight lives were lost in what many described as an act of impunity, lawlessness, and

desperation. As if that was not enough, on the 1st April, *Joy News* reported another fatal *galamsey* pit collapse in Mpasatia, which claimed two lives. The victims, driven by economic hardship, met their end in an unsafe, unregulated site that had already been earmarked as hazardous.

Similarly, on 16th July, 2025, Akyem Wenchi recorded yet another tragedy when four persons perished in a *galamsey* pit collapse. Eyewitnesses described harrowing scenes of community members using crude tools in desperate rescue attempts. Just on Tuesday, 29th July 2025, a 50-year-old woman tragically slipped and fell into an abandoned *galamsey* pit. Although she was quickly rescued and rushed to the Frimpong Boateng Clinic, she was pronounced dead upon arrival. Mr Speaker, how many more lives must be lost before urgent and decisive action is taken?

The prevalence of death and environmental collapse is a direct consequence of ineffective enforcement, lack of political will, and in some instances, the complicity of state actors and traditional authorities. While security operations have been launched and some arrests made, a number of these closed illegal mining sites resume activity within six months, pointing to a vicious cycle of impunity. Mr Speaker, *galamsey* is not simply an environmental issue; it is a national security threat. It fuels local conflicts, deepens poverty, and exposes our youth to preventable deaths.

In light of this, the Mahama-led Government should leverage real-time surveillance through drone technology and satellite imaging, anchored in the visionary digitalisation agenda of His Excellency Dr Mahamudu Bawumia, to enhance monitoring of high-risk mining zones and enable swift response to emerging illegal activities. This digital infrastructure, once mocked and misunderstood by our opponents, now presents a strategic tool to combat the *galamsey* menace with precision, transparency, and accountability. Further, Mr Speaker, the Government should revitalise and invest in community-based mining cooperatives, established under the previous government, not only change their names, and bring them under a robust regulatory framework that enforces strict environmental and safety standards. These cooperatives must serve as legal, safe, and economically viable alternatives to illegal mining, especially for youth and rural populations who are most vulnerable to exploitation in the *galamsey* economy.

Mr Speaker, in conclusion, every Ghanaian life matters. We cannot continue to treat the deaths from *galamsey* pits as collateral damage. These are not accidents, they are avoidable tragedies resulting from policy gaps, institutional inertia, and sometimes, deliberate negligence.

Let us be bold. Let us act now. The cost of inaction is not just economic—it is human. I thank you, Mr Speaker.
[Hear! Hear!]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Statement ably presented and it is for your comment. Yes, Hon Sosu, you have the floor.

Mr Francis-Xavier Kojo Sosu (NDC — Madina): Mr Speaker. I want to thank my Hon Colleague for this important Statement that he has made. I have always argued that when we fail in the fight against *galamsey*, we will be failing the next generation yet unborn. Mr Speaker, in accordance with the rules of intergenerational equity, every generation must use the natural resources that are available to them in a way that can guarantee its usage in the future. Unfortunately, that is not what we are seeing today. People are hell-bent on destroying our water bodies and our natural environment for their own parochial interests.

Mr Speaker, this cannot continue. The number of deaths and accidents that are associated with this illegal mining sometimes are very alarming. The numbers that we have here are those that were reported. Those that are not reported, when the pits cave in are much more. So, Mr Speaker, I believe that it is time for us, indeed, to take a decisive action in dealing with this menace.

That is why I want to commend Government for the effort made so far, even though I believe that more must be done again, to bring this under control. For example, the introduction of the Blue Water Guards is an important intervention. Recently, the Legislative Instrument (L.I.) that allows for mining

in forest reserves have also been revoked. I believe that these are very decisive steps that have been taken to deal with this menace.

I am hoping that in dealing with this problem, we will take a non-partisan approach so that it will not be the politics as usual when it has to deal with issues of *galamsey*. If we can do this, I believe that we will achieve the ultimate goal. It will be so long and hard, we know it. The road may be weary and muddy, but, if we are determined and keep fighting forward, one day we shall get there. Thank you, Mr Speaker. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Stephen Amoah?

Dr Stephen Amoah (NPP — Nhyiaeso): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for this opportunity. Mr Speaker, this whole issue of *galamsey*, in my opinion, has been one of the most important tests for the two governments, the Minority and the Majority, for the National Democratic Congress (NDC) fraternity as a party and New Patriotic Party (NPP) especially when we are in government. The first thing is that we should all bow down our heads in shame at the devastation that it is causing us as a people in our society. This menace of anti-social behaviour and activities contributed immensely towards the decision-making processes of the ordinary Ghanaian against NPP when we were in government. It was used as if what is happening was caused by our Government. We had hope. Ghanaians had faith.

3:06 p.m.

They believed in our Brothers in opposition, thinking that within the shortest possible time, *galamsey* would be a thing of the past. What do we see today? It is even aggravating. I would never blame the National Democratic Congress (NDC) Government. I want to be a good citizen. But I am asking them first to apologise to Ghanaians for [...*Expunged by order of Mr Speaker.*] to us.

Mr Speaker, the [...*Expunged by order of Mr Speaker.*], the propaganda, and the [...*Expunged by order of Mr Speaker.*], they told Ghanaians [...*Expunged by order of Mr Speaker.*] let us all understand the fact that some of these issues must be given the needed national attention, devoid of politics, because it is destroying us. Let us work on our mindset revolution. Change the way we use propaganda in [...*Expunged by order of Mr Speaker.*] Ghanaians because of political capital. It is extremely important.

Having said this, I would like to also appeal to all relevant stakeholders, especially our chiefs. Mr Speaker, some of our chiefs are behind it; they sell these pieces of land to the *galamsey* boys. I am also appealing to the security agencies. The former President, His Excellency Nana Addo Dankwa Akufo-Addo, in good faith, set up a task force. They went into the bush, and what happened? I am sure His Excellency John Dramani Mahama, in good faith, is doing everything that he can, setting up the same task force. They would go in there

and the story would not change. Why? Because if somebody travels like two hours, goes deep into the forest, how can they have control over them?

So, I think it is a national issue that all of us should stop the politicisation and begin to confront this together. The NDC and the New Patriotic Party (NPP) should come together and deal with those who are engaging in these antisocial behaviours because it is costing us economically. Already, we have the fiscal space confronted with a lot of challenges. We are, however, using the rationed budget we have as a country, addressing these things. People are dying.

Biologically, we are not even sure what we eat, what it contains, whether they contain hard metals or not. It is not an issue to play with or laugh about because one is either NDC or NPP. It is a national issue that is endangering the future of the next generation and posterity. So, I would like us, as a House, whether NDC or NPP, to support this current Government in a way that we can deal with *galamsey*. I am sure when my brothers were [...*Expunged by order of Mr Speaker.*] to Ghanaians, they never thought they would come to power. The same way I am talking to my people. Ghanaians know that in 2028, NPP, we are coming. We want to come and inherit a society —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you are a senior Member. You should be guided by the use of some languages; — and —. I would give a consequential order that those words be expunged.

Dr Amoah: Mr Speaker, I withdraw that with your leave, and I am sorry, House, I did not mean to use it. All that I am trying to say is that some of the national issues that are dwindling the goodwill and the reputation and the progress —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You should also be reminded of Order 93(5).

Dr Amoah: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

In conclusion, all that I am trying to say is that it is time that the NDC and the NPP sit down over certain national issues of great concern and deal with them without politics. We cannot allow these fundamentals to dwindle the reputation, progress, and economic stability of our country because of politics. I think the next stakeholder interest group that I would like to speak to is the media. What do they tell people about *galamsey*? What kind of reportage? Because somebody is in government or in opposition, they would report as if it is being confronted with. Mr Speaker, *galamsey* is now even done at train stations. It is costing us about US\$22 million or pounds. Where are we heading towards? So, it is a national issue. That is all I am saying. And then, we in opposition would not behave like them, we would support them, but they should go back and tell Ghanaians that they — and they are sorry. That is all I can say.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Richard Acheampong (NDC — Bia East): Mr Speaker, I was listening to my Colleague from the other Side and he

put up a figure. All of us are interested in this matter; we want to fight this menace. So, if he could share the data with us. He cannot just throw numbers to all of us without getting the real data. Let us get the content of it so that all of us would support each other to fight this menace. Where is the research work? He should give us the data so that all of us can help each other to fight it.

Thank you very much.

Dr Amoah: Mr Speaker, I thought I was supposed to — Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Alamzy Nikyema Billa (NDC — Chiana-Paga): Mr Speaker, I want to first of all commend the maker of the Statement. This is an important Statement for this House and for Ghana. We need to come together and fight *galamsey* without fear, favour, or political lens. Mr Speaker, I wish to thank His Excellency John Dramani Mahama. I am sure President Mahama is a relative of Jesus Christ [*Hear! Hear!*] for bringing in National Anti-Illegal Mining Operations Secretariat (NAIMOS) and Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) to help in fighting *galamsey*.

Mr Speaker, EPA is in with innovation. The EPA and NAIMOS are going to help us as a country to fight *galamsey* very well. And this is the best way to go —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, First Deputy Minority Whip?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu (NPP — Tolon): Mr Speaker, the contribution of the Member would be captured by *Hansard*. He just said President Mahama is a relative of Jesus Christ. [*Uproar*] Mr Speaker, it is factually incorrect, and for that matter, he should withdraw it. Our President is not a relative of Jesus Christ so he should withdraw it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon First Deputy Minority Whip, do you know what is a figurative speech? Hon Member, you may continue.

Mr Nikyema Billa: Mr Speaker, I want to correct my Leader. I did not say that President Mahama is a brother of Jesus Christ. I said, “I am sure”. That is quite different from what he said. [*Uproar*]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Order! Order!

Hon Members, this is not my first time of hearing that. I have even heard Junior Jesus in this country? We have all heard Junior Jesus in this country so I do not see anything offensive in the Statement made by the Hon Member.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the Statement the Hon Member is making is factually incorrect. Our President is not a family member of Jesus Christ. [*Uproar*] He is not.

3:16 p.m.

The President is a Gonja man by tribe from Bole Bamboi in the Savannah region. [*Uproar*] He is not related to Jesus Christ in any way.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon First Deputy Minority Whip, do you also want to be a family member of Jesus Christ? [*Laughter*]

Hon Member, please continue.

Mr Nikyema Billa: Thank you, Mr Speaker. Once again, I am very sure H.E. John Dramani Mahama is a brother or a relative of Jesus Christ. As I said earlier, the Environmental Protection Authority (EPA) and the National Anti-Illegal Mining Operations Secretariat (NAIMOS) have tabled the best way to fight *galamsey*. The best way is to strengthen our legal and regulatory framework. That is the way to go for us to fight *galamsey*. And by doing that, we must make sure that we keep updating our legislation to address the loopholes in existence.

Mr Speaker, it is very important for us to bring the kingpins that are involved in *galamsey* for the law to take care of them. It is very important for us to do community engagement. I can tell the House that most of the young men engaging in *galamsey* today do not know what they are doing. They are working for kingpins. When they are arrested and you check the videos, they do not look like people who can really afford excavators and other equipment that are being used to destroy our land.

Mr Speaker, we need to provide alternative livelihood. If we are able to provide our young men with better paid jobs, I am sure *galamsey* is going to be a thing of the past. We need to make sure that we empower our law enforcement agencies, provide adequate training,

resource them and make sure that they are being paid very well, so that when they get to the *galamsey* sites, they will not be enticed with the small money given to them which prevents them from doing their work.

Mr Speaker, we need to have stakeholder engagement. We have district chief executives in all the areas where *galamsey* is ongoing. We have chiefs there, commanders of the Police Service, Immigration Service and all the other forces as well present in those areas but *galamsey* is still ongoing. It is very important for us to do that engagement and make sure, if possible, we put individual's work on the line at various *galamsey* sites. If you are a police commander and you cannot bring your people together to fight *galamsey*, then you do not deserve to be the commander at that particular place.

Mr Speaker, I want to commend the maker of the Statement again and pray that the House takes this particular Statement seriously and make sure we all come together without political lens to fight *galamsey* very well, for the sake of our children, Ghana and ourselves. Thank you very much. And still, John Mahama must be a brother of Jesus Christ.

Prof Kingsley Nyarko (NPP — Kwadaso): Mr Speaker, you are welcome back from Canada. I am happy for the opportunity to make few comments on the Statement ably made by the Hon Member for Manhyia North, Mr Akwasi Konadu. Honestly, I do not know what to say about this matter,

because we have been discussing the illegal mining (*galamsey*) menace in this country for a very long time. It seems that we are not finding the practical solutions to deal with this menace. We come here and all that we do is to talk, so fighting *galamsey* has been reduced to a talk shop. And for me, we need to be worried about our attitude and the continuation of this menace.

Mr Speaker, if we are serious and we want to defeat the enemies who are engaged in this canker, the power lies in the hands of the Executive led by His Excellency the President. No other body or person can help us to win the war. The President must show leadership. He must lead the way to defeat this canker. It is becoming so worrisome and sad that we are destroying this country. We are depriving posterity the opportunity to benefit from the goodness of this country. We have the right to mine but we must do that responsibly. Why do we allow few persons to degrade and destroy our water bodies and our forests? Why should we look on for this to happen? We come to the House and issue Statements; we go to the media and talk. The talk is too much. We must begin to act, show the way as leaders and ensure that we make this country a better place.

All of us can decide to go into this venture but life is not all about money. Life is not all about mundane things. Life is securing the future for those who will come after us and we are not doing that. The President is not doing that. When it gets to election campaign period, then all the promises are given. Politicians are benefiting from this canker that is why

we are seeing inertia and inaction in fighting it. And is it fair? Is it fair to those through whose toil and blood bequeathed this country to us? Is it fair? If our forefathers had engaged in this illicit activity, degraded and destroyed our water bodies and forests, would we have come to benefit? We must do something. President Mahama must do something. The President has a term to rule us; he must show leadership. He needs to let Ghanaians know that he was the President who was able to fight and defeat this menace. [Uproar] Why? Money?

Mr Speaker, we came into this life with nothing and we shall go with nothing. All the moneys we get through all these illegal activities will be left here. And who suffers? Our children will suffer. Those yet unborn will suffer. So, I would like to urge the President that he must act and he must act now. The talking is too much. Ghanaians are not interested in our talks. They are interested in our actions. Let us act. The mighty Majority should please show leadership. They should let Ghanaians believe in them that they promised to defeat illegal mining and they have lived by their words. They sit there and stay quiet. The “vim” they used to campaign is gone because they are benefiting—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, be reminded of Order 93(5)

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I would not want to continue boring the House with words. What I expect from our President and this House is to ensure that we win the war against *galamsey*. We

can win if we want to win it. We do not want to win the fight against *galamsey* because of the benefits that we are getting; the mundane things that we are getting. Is that all we want? [Uproar] We are in this House to ensure that this country is governed well. [Uproar]

Mr Speaker, let me again commend the maker of the Statement, Mr Akwasi Konadu, for once again bringing this matter to the fore. If this matter is not dealt with—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I have reminded you of Order 93(5).

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, if this matter is not dealt with effectively, I do not expect any Member of this House to issue another Statement on fighting illegal mining next time. Thank you, Mr Speaker. [Uproar]

3:26 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, before turning to my right side, permit me to acknowledge the presence of the following visitors in our midst.

We have members of the Conference of Heads of Basic Schools (COHBS) from the Buem Constituency and are led by their chairman, Mr Wisdom Homey. They are 41 in number. I believe the Hon Member for Buem and Minister for Sports and Recreation is in the House. We also have the students of New Heaven Montessori School, Teshie, in the Ledzokuku Constituency, and they

are led by the headteacher, Mr Solomon Otuboa. They are 47 in number.

We have students of Nana Etsen Kofi (NATEKO) International in the Ahanta West Constituency. They are led by the headteacher, Mr Eric Mensah, and are 33 in number. We also have students of Beverly Hills Academy from the Hohoe Constituency and are led by the proprietor, Rev Larrie Davids. They are 155 in number. Finally, we have members of the Flouri Local Pensioners Association from the Akuapem South Constituency. They are 46 in number and are led by Ms Christiana Mantey, Assistant Director of NCCE, Akuapem South Municipal Assembly.

Hon Members, on your behalf, I welcome all of them to Parliament of the Republic of Ghana. May you all have a fruitful visit to Parliament. Thank you very much for coming. I hope your respective MPs will attend to you.

[Members of Conference of Heads of Basic Schools, Jasikan Municipality, were acknowledged]

[Students of New Heaven Montessori School, Teshie, were acknowledged]

[Students of Nana Etsen Kofi (NATEKO) International, Ahanta West, were acknowledged]

[Students of Beverly Hills Academy, Hohoe, were acknowledged]

[Members of Flouri Local Pensioners Association, Akuapem South, were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Isaac Adongo, you have the floor.

Mr Isaac Adongo: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

I would like to commend the maker of this Statement, but also to emphasise that if there is anybody in this country who can fix this problem, it is H. E. John Dramani Mahama, and that no matter how people shout on top of the roof, Ghanaians are aware of how they destroyed our country. It is not how angry they get; it is about the solutions that will fix the problem.

Only a few days ago, we heard people who said they will not stop *galamsey* today, they will not stop it tomorrow because they want to win power. We heard people who said that their Party needed money, and that *galamsey* was the way their Party could raise money. Mr Speaker, we were in this country when people told us that they had put their presidency on the line and ended up with their presidency at home, leaving us with *galamsey*.

So, Mr Speaker, we are not interested in people who are pontificating today. We are interested in the solutions that are being proffered to solve this problem. We are making sure that the laws that enable people to go and mine in our forest reserves are being revoked today so that nobody can go to the forest reserves to mine gold and destroy the environment.

Mr Speaker, I would like to call on my Colleagues that their newfound love

for the fight against *galamsey* is welcoming. But they should remember to tell the people of Ghana the path that they took, the things that they did, the evil that they did against this country in destroying our environment. They cannot all of a sudden become holier than thou. It is not how much they shout; Ghanaians are aware of their track record. We know that when it comes to paying lip service to the fight against *galamsey*, it started from their end. And it will not change today because they have made a simple Statement on *galamsey*.

Mr Speaker, I would like to emphasise that by the time H. E. John Dramani Mahama leaves office, he would have left the people of Ghana with a safe environment and *galamsey* will be a thing of the past. We are doing a lot to ensure that their lives are safe, their children are safe, not just ours, but theirs as well. We are making sure that the environment that they destroyed will be reclaimed. And they should be clapping for President John Dramani Mahama for wanting to save their environment.

Mr Speaker, when we tell people not to politicise any activity, it must start with us. We cannot tell people not to politicise so that they can gag people and turn around to politicise it. If they decide to politicise it, we will meet them boot for boot. H. E. John Dramani Mahama did not start *galamsey*, but he will stop it. I want to thank them for recognising today that in the past, they were the bane of this country and they have found a new love to stop *galamsey*. They must tell their friends who were *galamseying*

and are still *galamseying* to stop. They should stop parading the courts and demonstrating when people are arrested for engaging in *galamsey*. When people's equipment are seized for engaging in *galamsey*, they should not be the ones fighting for them.

Mr Speaker, they stood here and said they were not going to attend to this House because somebody had been accused of engaging in *galamsey*. They said they were not going to attend to Business in this House until Wontumi was freed. But they left him languishing and came to the House. It is those activities and attitudes that make the fight against *galamsey* difficult.

Mr Speaker, no amount of shouting will stop us from fighting *galamsey*; we will fight *galamsey*. H. E. John Dramani Mahama will win the fight against *galamsey* and shame the devil. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Leadership?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I am not commenting on the Statement, but I want to draw your attention to Order 93(5). With your permission I read:

“A member may comment on a statement for a period not exceeding five minutes and the comment shall not provoke debate”

So, Mr Speaker, I just want your guidance. Everything that Mr Adongo

said was provoking debate. He attacked the former President, Nana Addo Danquah Akufo-Addo, when he said he was putting his presidency on the line, and so many other things. Let it be known that we are guided by Order 93(5), and Mr Adongo, as a senior Member of this House, should know that his comment on the Statement should not provoke debate. Besides, everything that he has said is not true; they are all lies.

Mr Adongo: Mr Speaker, what I said is a matter of fact. His Excellency the former President said it in this House, that he was putting his presidency on the line. And when he ended his term, the presidency went home, but we were left with *galamsey*.

How is that provoking debate? Am I not allowed to say the things the former President has said on the floor of this House?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, nobody has ever said that we were not coming to this Chamber because they have arrested somebody on *galamsey*.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Members, on this note, we have another Statement. So, I want to take comment from Leadership.

Hon Members, the Statement emanated from the Minority Side so, I have given the opportunity to the Leadership of the Majority. Well, what is your pleasure? Because I have indicated we have another Statement. And I think I have taken more than three contributions.

Yes, Leadership of the House, you appear to be conversing among yourselves. Let me hear from you.

Mr George Kweku Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, I think I will just go by what the Hon Minority Leader said that we take one from each Side and then Leadership.

3:36 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, if I understood you, there should be one from each Side before I come to Leadership.

Well, if I understand you, it would be one from each Side, then we would go to Leadership.

Yes, Hon Nitiwul.

Mr Dominic Bingab Aduna Nitiwul (NPP — Bimbilla): Thank you, Mr Speaker and Leadership, for the opportunity.

Mr Speaker, the former President, Nana Addo Dankwa Akufo-Addo, came to this House in 2017, the year he took over power and said he was putting his presidency on the line in the fight against *galamsey*. It tells us only one thing: *galamsey* was already there before he came.

Mr Speaker, Ashanti Goldfields Corporation (AGC) closed down because of *galamsey*. It was under my signature that AGC reopened in 2022. In fact, the Communication Director of AGC died on the field when his own

pickup truck ran over him because *galamsefers* were chasing him. They closed down; they lost jobs because of *galamsey*. This was under President John Mahama.

Mr Speaker, the former Minister for Lands, because he is not here, I would not mention his name; we all know him. He went from the Ministry of Lands to the Ministry of Roads. He said, and I quote, “*galamsey* fight is very difficult.” We can ask him. The point I am making is that *galamsey* intensified in this country from 2013 to 2016. I was Deputy Leader in this House. That was the reason Nana Addo Dankwa Akufo-Addo said he was putting his presidency on the line.

What we did first, and I want them to do the same if they want to fight *galamsey*, was to ban all small-scale mining for a minimum of eight months. We started with eight months. After that, we increased it to 12 months. We increased the ban on all surface mining for at least one year. The Minister, Hon Kofi Armah Buah, came to this House to say that nine forest reserves that had not been touched before have been taken over by *galamsey*.

Mr Speaker, yesterday, their Member of Parliament was arrested protecting *galamsey* and they blame us? No, they cannot blame us. I am speaking because of what Hon Adongo said. No MP so far has been accused or arrested because of *galamsey*. But an NDC Member of Parliament led thugs to attack security forces because of *galamsey*, and they have the audacity to accuse us?

Mr Speaker, in those days, any time I deployed soldiers to go and fight *galamsefers*, they said that when they come into power, they would not allow that. They always said that, and I have videos, if Hon Members want, I will play the videos here. I will play the videos where NDC people were going around saying that they will leave them.

Mr Speaker, the current President said he will release the young boys who were arrested for *galamsey*. They are not a problem; they are the *pikins*. Nine months into power, why are they not arresting those supposed “big people? They did not have power; today, they are in power, so why are they not arresting them?

Mr Speaker, 5,000 excavators were moved at night. Why are they not arresting the supposed “big people”? Why are they shielding the “big people”? The people of Ghana have given them power, not just power; they have given them an overwhelming power to ask why these people are not being arrested. It is because they are complacent, and that is why they are not arresting them. They are not arresting them because they are the people doing it. Otherwise, arrest them. Arrest the *galamsefers*. They are not arresting them because the NDC people are doing it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Dr Stephen Amoah, we listened to you in silence. Why would you not want to listen to the former Leader in silence?

Mr Nitiwul: Mr Speaker, I was responding to Hon Adongo, but now, let

me calm down and speak like an MP—
[Laughter]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Nitiwul, be reminded of Order 95(5).

Mr Nitiwul: Thank you.

Mr Speaker, let me state that if one ever visits a *galamsey* community, it is not a good sight. If one ever goes to look for water to drink from a *galamsey* community, it is not a good sight. You and I can get fish from the Volta Lake to at least prepare soup; they cannot.

Mr Speaker, the youth are being destroyed because of *galamsey* and what is painful is that somebody will have his cocoa farm, and the Mineral Commission will sit in Accra and issue a permit, and they will go and destroy their cocoa farms. The former First Deputy Speaker, Joe Osei Owusu, says he cannot visit his cocoa farm because *galamsey* has invaded and taken over the whole place. If they can do that to a former Speaker, what about the ordinary farmer in the village?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: When did they do that to Joe Osei Owusu?
[Some Hon Members: Last month]

Mr Nitiwul: They seized it last month. He told me that from September to October, *galamseyers* seized his farm.

Mr Speaker, all I am saying is that our land is being destroyed, the livelihood is being destroyed, and we moved with force to go and stop them. If we continue to send just two or five

soldiers to the field, we are putting their lives at risk. I never sent less than 100 soldiers to go and fight *galamsey* because I know that what happened at Asutifi North can happen to them. Can we imagine what would have happened if a soldier had been killed in Asutifi North?

So I am advising the Government to ban all surface mining for one year, like we did. Have a grip and declare the state of emergency that we asked for. I am not going to ask for it, but I am saying it is very easy to ban all surface mining for one year. We did it, they can do it. They say they know the people who practise *galamsey*. Go and arrest them. Why are they not arresting them?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Nitiwul, your time is up.

Mr Nitiwul: Mr Speaker, we know the solution, and the solution is that the Government must act. If the Government is not acting, we will accuse them of not acting because their people are involved. So, if they do not want us to accuse them, they should act and act now.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Richard Acheampong.

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, I will allow Hon Fred Agbenyo to speak after that; Hon Adjei Mensah will come in.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, we have agreed to have one on each Side, so

if your Leadership will yield to one of them.

Mr Acheampong: We will yield the Leadership slot to him after the Minority Leader has spoken?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, you have the floor.

Mr Fred Abgenyo (NDC — Guan): Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity to contribute to this Statement.

Mr Speaker, when the former Minister for Defence was speaking, I thought Hon Habib was going to remind him of Order 93(5). [**Some Hon Members:** What does it say?] I can give them a copy to read if they want to know.

3:46 p.m.

Mr Speaker, unfortunately, Hon Habib did not hear him when he was provoking debate. He sat down quietly and allowed him to say the things he said. The good news is that the people of this country know that if there is any government or the only President who can solve the *galamsey* problem of our country is none other than Mr John Dramani Mahama. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr Speaker, the people of Ghana saw their record the past eight years. We saw them in office in the last eight years, when they told the people of this country that their party was looking for money and the only way they could get money was to be engaged in *galamsey* activities. They turned the Ministry of

Environment, Science, Technology and Innovations into an office where they were sharing *galamsey* among themselves. Their Members were involved in *galamsey*. When they were leaving office, they had polluted all the river bodies in the *galamsey* mining areas and destroyed all our vegetation. The former Minister for Defence wants to know who we have arrested.

As we speak today, their Ashanti Regional Chairman is facing trials— They said they wanted to know the people we have arrested and I am telling them that he is facing trial. So, we are going to go after all the big people who are living in Accra, sponsoring the young people to mine in our forests to destroy our water bodies. If they want to see them, they should just exercise patience. Very soon, they would see all of them. They are going to pay back for all the vegetation they have destroyed with their properties and the wealth they have acquired. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr Speaker, we want to assure the people of this country that President Mahama will not just make a vague promise of putting his Presidency on the line, but he is going to live the talk. He is going to make sure that by the time he leaves office, *galamsey* will become a thing of the past. Mr Speaker, I am not surprised that anytime *galamsey* is mentioned in this House, you hear some people screaming and shouting. Even when their names have not been mentioned, because they know what they did in the past eight years, their thinking is that we are coming to talk about them. But we are going to make sure that

galamsey will stop in our forests. We are going to make sure that our water bodies will be clean, so that we can get good water to drink. We are going to make sure that they are going to reclaim all the lands that were destroyed as a result of *galamsey* and we are going to make sure, as the President said, that any appointee of the Government who is seen engaging in any *galamsey* activity, that person will be prosecuted.

We have seen what President Mahama, has done so far. When his own party officials were accused of engaging in *galamsey*, he did not even wait for a day. He asked the security agencies to investigate them. During their time, the President himself was clearing those who were involved in *galamsey*; President Mahama will not do that. If one is an NDC member, a Minister, a Member of Parliament, or a Chief Executive Officer and is involved in *galamsey*, the law of the land will deal with them.

Mr Speaker, once again, thank you very much for the opportunity. Let me assure my Colleagues that President Mahama, *woaye bi da, obeye bi biom*. He will solve the problem of *galamsey* once and for all.

Thank you very much. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Leadership. Yes, Mr Kwabena Boateng, you have the floor.

Mr Kwabena Boateng (NPP — Ejisu): Thank you, Mr Speaker. Let me

also commend the maker of the Statement on this very important matter.

Mr Speaker, respectfully, we have a consensus in this House and as a matter of fact, the entire country which is in respect of the effect of *galamsey* on our lives. Our medical doctors are telling us that our women are giving birth to creatures that they cannot characterise as to whether they are proper human beings or otherwise. Babies are born without limbs and what we cannot properly call human beings. All these are emanating from very strange chemicals associated with *galamsey*.

Mr Speaker, it is also the case that the consensus that we have in this House, particularly, the promise that was given by the incumbent Government when they sought power from the people of Ghana was that, there was a magical button which the Government of the day could press to stop *galamsey* one time. That was the indication that was given to us that there was something that the erstwhile Government could do and *galamsey* would have come to a halt immediately. Mr Speaker, we were also urged on to declare a certain state of emergency which was also said to be the panacea to the *galamsey* menace.

Mr Speaker, today the people of Ghana believed in that promise and bought into the idea. The people of Ghana were looking for people who could press that magical button and bring an immediate halt to the *galamsey* menace. Today, we do not know where that magical button is. Today, the Government that advertised the

declaration of a state of emergency, has lost the power and zeal to talk about the state of emergency that they advertised so much to win political power.

Mr Speaker, the history is very clear. From 2013 when the National Democratic Congress (NDC) set up an Inter-Ministerial Committee to look at *galamsey*, we were told at the latter part of their tenure that fighting *galamsey* was a shared responsibility. I am using the words of the Chairman of Inter-Ministerial Committee Hon Inusah Fuseini, in 2013, who said, fighting *galamsey* was a “shared responsibility.”

Mr Speaker, we do not know what happened in 2016 when we came to power. All of a sudden, fighting *galamsey* became our sole responsibility and that we could not even invite our friends from the other Side to join in that fight; we found this very worrying.

Mr Speaker, in 2010, during the tenure of the NDC Government, the journalist Anas Aremeyaw Anas featured a documentary in Wassa-Akropong involving *galamsey* and how the lives of innocent people had been lost in that documentary attributed to *galamsey* in the tenure of the NDC Government.

Mr Speaker, is it also not the case that in 2015, the then Minister for Finance, the Hon Seth Terkper, lamented about the reduction of cocoa production which was also attributed to *galamsey*.

Mr Speaker, today, the power is in the hands of the NDC Government. Not long ago, they refused our invitation to

join us to jaw-jaw. They said that the blame was to be laid at the doorstep of Government, the Executive, the erstwhile NPP Government. They said the blame was to be laid at our doorstep.

Mr Speaker, today, we do not want to go the same way. We would want to show good faith. We will accept the invitation. But then, the charge must be led by the Government. They are the custodians of the electoral power of the people. This Side is ready to help in any manner or form to fight *galamsey*. But they must show leadership. The President must set the example. The President must lead the charge, so that all of us as a country can also join in bringing an end to the *galamsey* menace.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I thank the maker of this Statement.
[Hear! Hear!]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Adjei Mensah, you have the floor.

3:56 p.m.

Mr Isaac Adjei Mensah (NDC — Wassa-East): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

I think it is so worrying when I hear from the other Side, the New Patriotic Party (NPP), taking about issues of *galamsey*. Some basic information for them. I have been a miner all my life, and I have worked with all the major international mining companies here in Ghana. I would have thought that the NPP will just keep quiet and support the Government in resetting Ghana and try

to resolve this *galamsey* challenge. Basic information for them, Mr Speaker, as at the time that National Democratic Congress (NDC) was exiting office, 99 prospecting licences had been given out, that is from the colonial times, through to H.E. John A. Kufuor's tenure; 99 prospecting licences had been given out. We saw *galamsey* escalating, and we managed it in a manner that will ensure consistency. Unfortunately, from 2017 to 2024, the NPP has given out over 2,100 prospecting licences. [**Some Hon Members:** Eii!] The records are there. Mr Speaker, 2,100 prospecting licences, and these were given to the NPP cronies. As we speak today, we have 83 mining districts. What happened was that they gave these over 2,100 prospecting licences to their cronies and they invited the Chinese who came in with their *Changfangs*, bulldozers and excavators. While they were licensed to prospect, they were mining. When we talk about *galamsey*, all small-scale miners are involved in *galamsey*, because if you do not have the legal permit to mine, you are obviously practising *galamsey*. Mr Speaker, what happened was that there was an escalation of *galamsey* all over. The records are available that many of them own three to six concessions. At the appropriate time, the records will come through.

Mr Speaker, I get worried when I talk about this. Dr Kwabena Frimpong-Boateng's report was clear. But the worrying aspect of it is that we thought they would be patient. Why are they calling for a State of Emergency? Do they know the consequences of State of Emergency? They created a mess and

never called for a State of Emergency. What President Mahama is saying is that we are resetting Ghana, and the mess that they have created in that sector, he is going to be fix them all.

During our campaign, we told Ghanaians that we were going to regularise and ensure that *galamsey* is done properly. Do you know what happened? We are undertaking a process. Do they know what the process is? Responsible cooperative mining. This responsible cooperative mining will ensure that all the tailings will be properly embanked and that they are all treated before we allow them to enter into the waters.

Mr Speaker, the boys that we promised during the campaign, that—*[Interruption]*—they are the small boys. The big ones are their people. They own the concessions. They own the big ones. If they dare us, we are going to publish all the names. They are over 2,000. Most of them have them. We are not here to talk about issues. We are fixing the problems. So in fixing the problems, we need them to exercise patience. How many of them brought in Chinese with their *Changfang*? [**An Hon Member:** Many.] The Chinese are their cronies.

Mr Speaker, we had artisanal mining during the colonial times. Why were we called Gold Coast?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member be reminded of Standing Order 93(5).

Mr I. A. Mensah: Mr Speaker, should I land now? All I am saying is that there is a major problem, and this major problem of illegal mining was escalated exponentially by the NPP. They do not have the moral right to talk about it. No government ever. It was the NPP that gave permits for mining in the forest. Tell me which government did that? It was the NPP that gave permit for the forest to be destroyed. You know what? We have cleared the forest. The nine major forests reserves have been cleared. The National Anti-Illegal Mining Operations Secretariat (NAIMOS) is in there to bring decency. The boys are now given the hope that indeed, we are in to reset Ghana and resolve the problem of *galamsey*. We are going to make sure that responsible cooperative mining comes to stay and is better. That is where we make sure that at every cooperative post or location, we get a geologist, a metallurgist, and an environmental expert. We will make sure that this time around, they are not going to be mining in the rivers. The NPP allowed *Changfangs* to be placed on rivers. It is not going to be done again. Now we are stopping them and we are stopping them forever.

So, Mr Speaker, I think that it is very clear that the NPP has been very irresponsible in managing our resources. The 2,100 licences were given by them. How many licences did we give out? So, they need to exercise patience. They have no moral right to talk about *galamsey*. President Mahama made it clear that we are fixing the problem; NAIMOS is in place. All the rivers are virtually being cleared: the Ankobra,

Densu, Pra and many other big rivers are getting better.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, conclude.

Mr I.A. Mensah: Why are they so worried? As for the State of Emergency, it is not coming today and it is not coming tomorrow. This because we have started a process to make sure that something is done. What is their justification to talk about this? They have been involved and are still involved in *galamsey*. At the appropriate time, the records will come through. But while I finish, Mr Speaker, I want us to be very clear, Ghana is for us. We are all Ghanaians. There is no country like Ghana. They started destroying the environment by bringing in the *Changfangs* and the Chinese people all over. The Chinese are in the village selling *gari* and all those things —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member your time is up.

Mr I. A. Mensah: Today, we see them going to all these areas. Mr Speaker, it is finished. We do not want to hear them talking about State of Emergency. Now, we are in a state of attention.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, your time is up.

Mr I. A. Mensah: We are in a state of attention. It means that attention is being given to the area after they destroyed it and so on and Ghana is

going to be better. *[Hear! Hear!]* Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we have another Statement, a congratulatory message to the Ghana Women's National Team, the Black Queens, standing in the name of Dr Ernest Norgbey.

**Congratulatory Message to the
Ghana Women's National Football
Team
(The Black Queens)**

Dr Ernest Henry Norgbey (NDC — Ashaiman): Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity to congratulate the Ghana Women's National Football Team, the Black Queens, for their commendable performance during the qualifying stages of the 2026 Women's Africa Cup of Nations to be held in Morocco. Indeed, our Queens displayed impressive competence, teamwork, tenacity and grit when they faced their Egyptian counterparts to deliver a 4-0 victory at the Accra Sports Stadium, securing a 7-0 aggregate conquest. We have a formidable midfield, diligent strikers, resilient defence and an agile goalkeeper, who made sure our goalpost was secured during their respective qualifying features. The Committee on Youth and Sports of Parliament is proud of their enviable achievement and congratulates them for this remarkable victory.

Mr Speaker, our coach and his technical team deserve special mention for their expertise, effective strategy and

support which led to the realisation of this covetable accomplishment. This triumph is indicative of the steady development of our Queens over the years. Our women's football has come a long way and we cannot ignore the sacrifices and determination of past and present players who have made what was once a dream, a reality. The major task lies ahead of us. I urge our Queens to aim for gold as an improvement to their 2024 performance as bronze medalists in the tournament. Mr Speaker, they are a force to reckon with, and I know they will do us proud.

Mr Speaker, the Committee on Youth and Sports of Parliament will continue to work together with the Ministry of Sports and Recreation, the Ghana Football Association and other relevant agencies to ensure the mobilisation of requisite resources to support preparation efforts and the stellar performance of the Black Queens. Black Queens, our young ladies are motivated by your achievements. Ghanaians are cheering you on. The Government is committed to your welfare and the whole universe is aligning for your victory. *Ayekoo*, Black Queens.

I thank you once again, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

4:06 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Dr Ernest Norgbey. Hon Members, Statement ably made. It is now for your contribution. Hon Members, any contribution? In the absence of any contribution, may we

move to the item numbered — Yes, Hon Deputy Majority Leader?

Mr George Kweku Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, I think we will move on to public Business and take the item numbered 8 and do some presentation of Papers. We have some Papers here that we want to present.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: At the commencement of public Business, the item numbered 8, “Presentation of Papers”. Yes?

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, the item numbered 8(1) was supposed to be presented by the Minister for Gender, Children and Social Protection, but the Minister is not here. So, I will seek your indulgence and ask the Minister for Foreign Affairs who is here to do that on her behalf.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Leader? Very well. Minister for Foreign Affairs, the item numbered 8(a).

PAPERS

By the Minister for Foreign Affairs (Mr Samuel Okudzeto Ablakwa) on behalf of the Minister for Gender, Children and Social Protection.

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Department of Social Welfare for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Gender, Children and Social Welfare.

By the Minister for Foreign Affairs (Mr Samuel Okudzeto Ablakwa) on behalf of the Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovation.

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Geological Survey Authority for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Information and Communication.

By the Minister for Foreign Affairs (Mr Samuel Okudzeto Ablakwa) on behalf of the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources.

- (i) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Forestry Commission for the year 2023.
- (ii) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Forestry Commission for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Deputy Majority Leader?

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, now, the item numbered 8(d) (i), (ii) and (iii).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I understand the item numbered 8(d) is supposed to be deferred. So, we then move to the Motion numbered 11. [Pause]

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, we will not look at the item numbered 8(d) because I understand the reports are not ready. I think we have actually exhausted —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, it is left with the item numbered 11. *[Pause]* Motion numbered 11 is standing in the name of the Hon Majority Leader on page 4 of the Order Paper for today.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, we are not taking that today.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, it is very clear that the Majority has no further Business to do, except that, I have a Motion pending on page 6, the Motion numbered 15. If you would permit me, I would like to move my Motion now.

Mr Speaker, this Motion is important because it will determine the form in which the Budget Statement and Economic Policy will be presented to this House. The first Budget of the Minister for Finance was in the form of a Statement, and after that, I raised issues with regard to the form that he presented the Budget. Subsequent Budgets came in the form of a Motion. I made this application, and I wanted to see if I could move the Motion today for it to be done.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon First Deputy Minority Whip, at Conclave, we reached some agreements, so I would not want any surprise where after agreeing on the Business to be done

for today, then we come to the Floor and spring surprises.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, you are very right, and I am guided by that, except that it has been pending for long. Even in the last Meeting, it was pending. We are very much aware that anytime soon this month, the Minister for Finance will be presenting the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy, but I am guided, as you have said. This is just to be on record that we should take this Motion soon.

To the Majority Chief Whip, this Motion I have filed, the Motion numbered 15 on page 6, on the Order Paper, even though the Speaker has given indication and guidance, — was a Motion that I filed and Rt Hon Speaker admitted, to the effect that we must determine the form in which the Budget Statement and Economic Policy should be submitted to this House. The first Budget Statement came in the form of a Statement by the Minister for Finance. The second one was a Motion, and this Motion seeks to bring clarity as to which form the Budget Statement and Economic Policy is to be submitted. Even though we are not moving it today by the indication of the Speaker, I want him to join me, so that we will be able to move this Motion and get it settled, as well as the Motion numbered 14, which has also been pending for long. Thank you.

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I have heard my Hon Brother, but if I recall correctly, I believe the Rt Hon Speaker gave an

indication to take this Motion himself, including the Motion moved by the Hon Minority Leader, and the debate of which Motion is still outstanding. So, I know that the Rt Hon Speaker has a particular interest in this matter.

4:16 p.m.

Mr Speaker, may I pray you that we defer this until the Speaker himself—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, before you came in, I had indicated that we had a pre-sitting meeting, and at the pre-sitting meeting, we agreed on the businesses that would be conducted in the House today. I would not want a situation where we agreed on the business to be conducted and then we would come here and spring surprises. Therefore, once the agreed business has been conducted— Deputy Majority Leader, any indication?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, if you had permitted me to— My point is that we had agreed on the business. So, this belated prayer is completely out of what we agreed on.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Exactly; that is what I am saying. We are speaking the same language.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I believe that we sat from 2:00 p.m., and we have not done five hours, so I move that the House be adjourned until tomorrow, 2:00 p.m., so that we can come back and do business tomorrow.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion moved for adjournment. Any seconder?

Mr Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I am not ready to second this Motion because we still want to do business. We are ready to do business, and I am ready to move my Motion.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion moved for adjournment. Any seconder?

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion moved by the Chief Whip.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion moved for adjournment and duly seconded. It is for the consideration of the House.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was accordingly adjourned at 4.17 p.m. till Thursday, 6th November, 2025, at 2.00 p.m.

